

Mrs. Ruth Dotson, Detroit, Michigan.

The following Friday the same two ladies came back quite smiling and with them a man with his head all shaven and one side quite tape-up Whom Mrs. Wheeler introduced: "...This is my husband.".....He had certainly given the doctors - Peet and Wood - of the Ann Arbor one of the surprises of their life; who together declared, as I have it in the said note "...miraculous that a patient should talk normally four days after such an operation." They had given him at the longest six months to live. I gave Mrs. Wheeler a copy of the "Conception" of Mary, viz, the first book of the "Mystical City of God" by Venerable Mother Mary of Agreda; that she might learn something in particular about the august Queen of Heaven our Blessed Mother Mary, that in this at least she might get an idea of how sadly those Christians are wanting in the out-standing feature of Christinity, "Devotion to Mary," who know little or nothing of the same BLESSED MOTHER OF GOD, save that in general she was just the Mother of Jesus.

About a year and a half afterwards, October 16th, she came to lament that her husband was not acting as he ought of late. I had not seen or heard from them since a week or so after said surprise visit. I asked her if she had kept her promise -- and particularly about the Blesses Virgin. She hung her head and acknowledged she had neglected to do so. A few nights afterwards they both came back and were seemingly quite happy and satisfied. They had evidently started earnestly to keep the promise she and probably both had made. At all events he especially seemed enthusiastic about the said Book. He surely looked and seemed to feel happy.

I have no doubt that if those parents of whom you wrote me - the one baptized a Catholic at least and the other, though good at heart, with little or no faith - would wake up and turn to the Good God they would get a happy surprise. In case they come to New York any time, I would be pleased to see them. In the meantime, we will hope and pray. God bless all.

Fr. Solanus

P.S. I just remembered that possibly someone would like to go to see the above mentioned Wheelers. When they called on me last year, according to my notes, they lived at 686 Manistique Ave., Detroit.